

# Everyone Else • 12/39 • Malik al-Ashtar

**The Man in the Market.** Imam Ali wrote Malik a letter about how to govern. Five items, no event print, dateless.

One style for the whole line — Fraunces and Nunito Sans, cut paper, the person on a stamp. Still open where it shows: the fact panel is TO VERIFY and the return address is not set.

ENVELOPE — C5, 229 × 162 MM

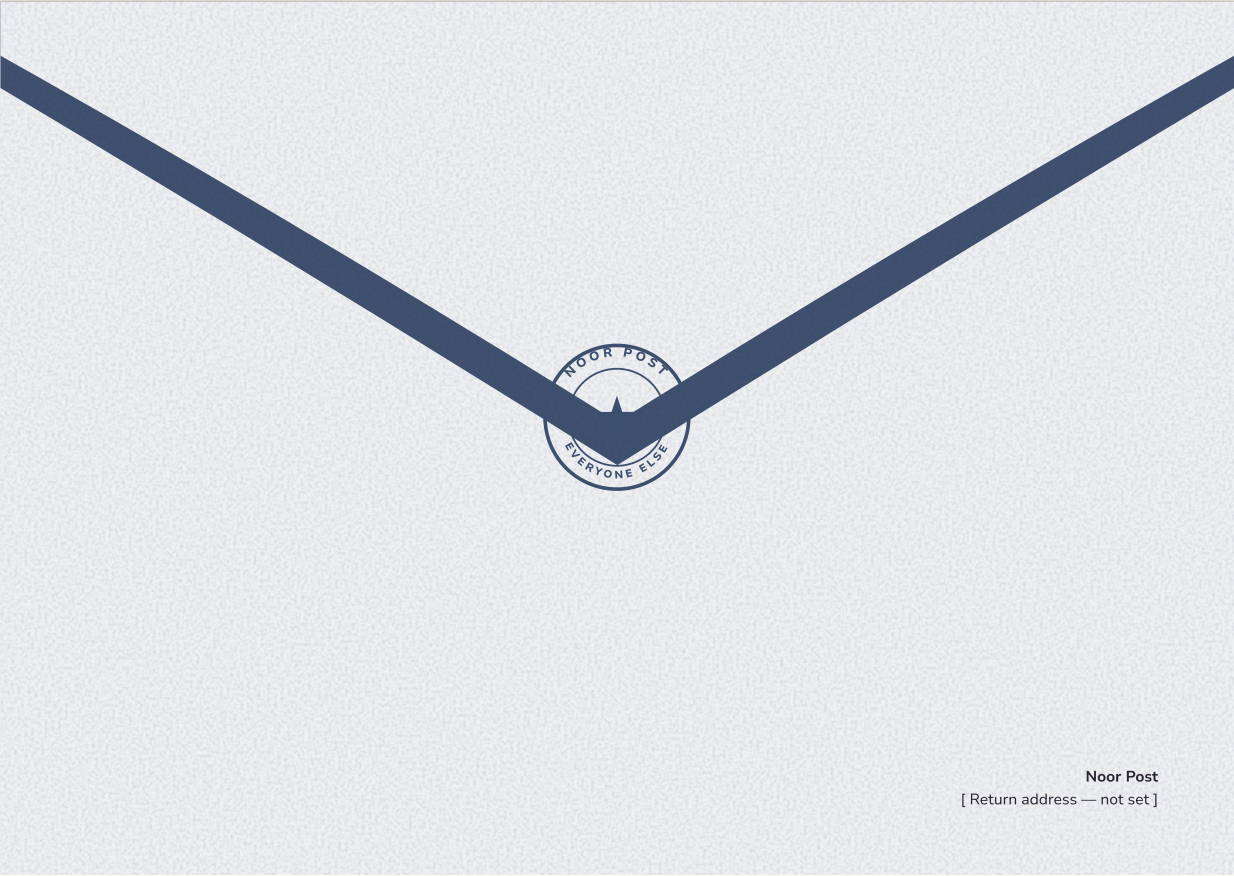
NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

**Imam Ali wrote Malik a  
letter about how to  
govern.**

FOR

**[Child's name]**





INSIDE THE FLAP

EVERYONE ELSE · MALIK  
AL-ASHTAR · INSIDE THE  
FLAP

## Open together.

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The print
- 4 The stickers
- 5 The postcard

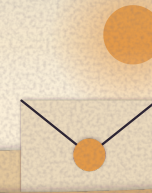
1 · THE LETTER — ONE A4 SHEET FOLDED TO A5

## Malik al-Ashtar

- **Who he was.** A commander from Kufa, and one of Imam Ali's most senior military figures. His name comes from an injury to his eye — *al-Ashtar*.
- **What he was known for.** Command, at the largest scale available in that empire, and a reputation among his enemies that is recorded by his enemies.
- **The letter.** Imam Ali appointed him governor of Egypt and sent him with a long letter of instructions — how to treat the people, the poor, the army, his own officials. **It is in Nahj al-Balagha and it is read now as a document about government, by people with no connection to any of this.**
- **What is in it.** Instructions to keep the ordinary people first, to be reachable, to be suspicious of advisers who flatter, and to never let anger decide anything.
- **What happened.** He never took up the post. He died on the road to Egypt, and the accounts say he was poisoned before he arrived.
- **Why he is in this envelope.** *Imam Ali wrote Malik a letter about how to govern.*

He died on the road to Egypt, before reaching it. The accounts hold that he was killed at the instigation of those he was being sent to replace.

## The Man in the Market



● is the grown-up · ○ is you · ●○ is together

- If you had seen him coming down a street you would have moved. He was a soldier, he was enormous, and he commanded armies. People who fought against him wrote about him afterwards the way you write about weather.

### ○ Was he scary?

- He was the most frightening man in his army, and his army knew it.

- One day he is walking through a market in Kufa in ordinary clothes. Nothing to say who he is. And a man at a stall — bored, showing off, playing to the people around him — throws something at him. Rubbish. Something off the floor.

### ○ At him? On purpose?

- On purpose, for a laugh, at a stranger he thought was nobody.

### ○ What did he do?

- Nothing. He kept walking. Did not turn round, did not say anything, did not look for him.

### ○ Really?

#### THE MAN IN THE MARKET • CONTINUED

- Really. And then somebody in that market grabbed the man's arm and told him who he had just done that to.

#### ◦ **Oh no.**

- The man went after him through the street to find him and apologise, and found him in the masjid, praying.

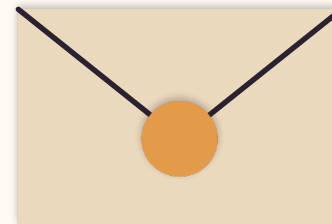
#### ◦ **What would you say to him? Say it out loud now.**

- And here is what he had gone in there for. He had gone in to ask forgiveness for the man who had thrown it — because he had worked out that the man was going to be terrified when he found out who he was, and he wanted that dealt with before it started.
- He was praying for him before the man knew he needed it.
- This is the person Imam Ali trusted with Egypt. He wrote him a letter about how to govern it — pages of it, about how to treat people who cannot do anything to you — and the reason we still read that letter is that it was written to someone who did not need it explained. It reads like advice. It was closer to a description.

#### SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦

**He could have done  
anything. He kept  
walking.**



Then the hadith card.



FIRST EDITION · 12/39

IMAM ALI SAID

**“The most capable of  
pardoning is he who is the  
most powerful to punish.”**

Imam Ali

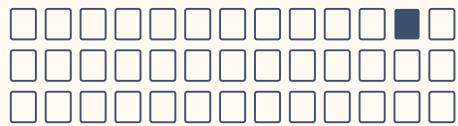


NOT A SILSILA SEGMENT · THIS SET HAS ITS OWN CHAIN

NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

The other chain

The box holds fourteen cards, one for each of the Fourteen.  
This set is the people around them: thirty-nine cards, collected  
in any order.



First edition · thirty-nine cards

IN OUR WORDS

**The person who could punish the most  
is the one best able to forgive.**

Noor Post's own words, not the translation.

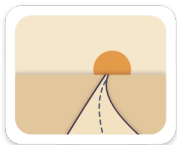
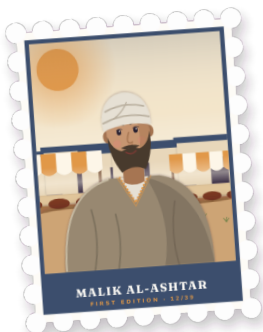
*Nahj al-Balagha*, Saying 52. Translated by Sayed Ali Reza.

Back — its own chain, no silsila number

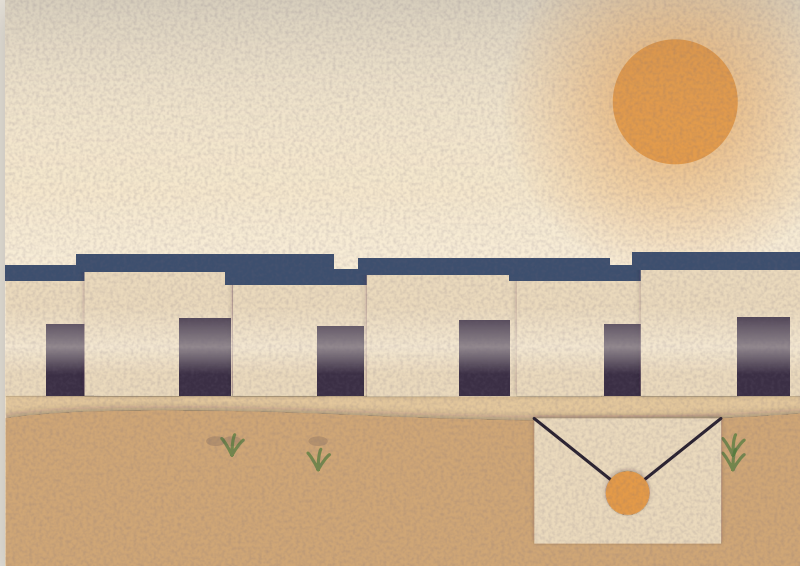


**Malik al-Ashtar**









**We opened this one  
together.**

- \_\_\_\_\_
- \_\_\_\_\_

*Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.*



**Noor Post**

[ Return address — not set ]

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